

SOC Investigation Timeline - Authentication Compromise

Simulated alert-to-escalation timeline for brute force followed by successful login

Time	Action	Evidence / decision
09:02	Alert generated	Brute-force detection identifies repeated failures from 203.0.113.44 against j.smith.
09:04	Tier 1 acknowledges	Confirms underlying events and that source is external documentation-range IP in the lab.
09:07	User/source search	14 failures found in approximately four minutes.
09:10	Success correlation	One password-only success appears from the same source.
09:13	Baseline review	User normally signs in from internal workstation with MFA.
09:16	Device/geo review	Successful event reports unknown device and unfamiliar location.
09:19	Scope expansion	No other successful logins from source; targeted-user history reviewed.
09:22	Severity raised	High severity because success + abnormal authentication context creates plausible account compromise.
09:25	Containment recommendation	Revoke session, reset credentials, require MFA, and block source where authorized.
09:28	Tier 2 escalation	Handoff includes timeline, source/user, evidence, disposition, containment, and post-login review request.

Tier 2 Handoff Summary

- **Disposition:** True Positive - Escalated.
- **Primary evidence:** 14 failures -> password-only success from same external source; unfamiliar device/location; user baseline uses MFA.
- **Scope:** One successful account compromise suspected; no additional successful accounts found in initial source-IP search.
- **Actions requested:** Review post-login cloud/mail activity, confirm user contact, inspect MFA changes/tokens, and determine whether broader incident response is required.
- **ATT&CK::** T1110 Brute Force describes the credential-guessing behavior; successful access then requires investigation of valid-account use.